

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI)

Lingering asset quality concerns and lower than peer div yield limits upside

UOBH.SI

12m Price Target: **S\$40.70**

Price: **S\$37.20**

Upside: **9.4%**

UOB posted 4Q25 net profit of S\$1,410mn, -7% yoy/+218% qoq, +5% vs. GSe (see [First Take: Beat on lower credit cost offsetting lower PPOP on weaker non-NII](#)). Asset quality was the key focus at the analyst briefing with CRE remaining an area of stress. Elevated new NPL formation in the quarter was largely CRE driven both from US and HK. We continue to see CRE as a lingering risk and, while our HK real estate analyst [expects](#) some stabilisation to small rises in CRE prices and rents this year, we believe the risk profile remains uneven. UOB has noted HK CRE is not out of the woods and banks in HK continue to highlight residual asset quality risk from HK CRE exposures on their balance sheet. We therefore remain watchful on this front. That said, provisions remain robust following earlier pre-emptive action in 3Q with GP coverage still at 1% into 4Q. We see this to provide buffer for potential deterioration in asset quality and we do not anticipate further large provisioning needed but given persistence of CRE related risk, we adopt a more cautious stance and forecast credit cost at the higher end of management guidance at 30bps for 2026-2028. The other focus was on capital and dividends. While CET1 ratio stood at 15.1%, above management's preferred operating range of 14.0-14.5%, and with capital likely to continue to build underpinned by muted RWA growth, management reiterated that it remains focused on executing the existing capital return programme, with no indication of additional measures to return more at this stage. As such, with dividend yield trailing peers, at 4.7% for 2026 vs DBS at 5.7%, the lack of incremental capital returns alongside the concerns on asset quality is likely to cap upside for the stock.

Post results, we revise our 2026-28 net income estimates by +0.3%/-0.6%/+0.1%, to S\$5,664mn/S\$5,949mn/ S\$6,259mn as we bake in better exit NIM in Jan offset by weaker fee growth guidance. Our 2 stage DDM target price of S\$40.7 remains unchanged.

NEUTRAL

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Key Data

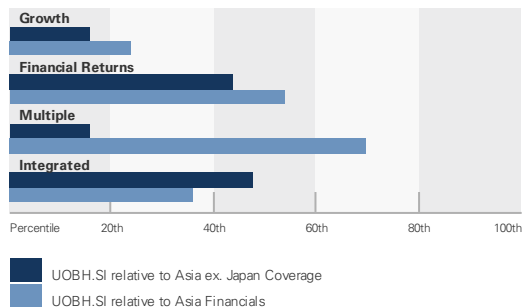
Market cap: S\$62.2bn / \$49.1bn
3m ADTV: S\$111.0mn / \$86.8mn
Singapore
Asia Financials
M&A Rank: 3

GS Forecast

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net inc. (S\$ mn) New	4,681.0	5,664.2	5,949.3	6,258.8
Net inc. (S\$ mn) Old	4,620.6	5,646.8	5,986.9	6,252.6
EPS (S\$) New	2.73	3.32	3.49	3.67
EPS (S\$) Old	2.70	3.32	3.52	3.68
EPS growth (%)	(22.4)	21.5	5.1	5.3
P/E (X)	13.1	11.2	10.7	10.1
P/B (X)	1.2	1.2	1.1	1.1
Price/PPOP (X)	8.1	7.9	7.6	7.2
Dividend yield (%)	4.4	4.7	4.9	5.1

	12/25	3/26E	6/26E	9/26E
EPS (S\$)	0.81	0.87	0.82	0.84

GS Factor Profile



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.
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NEUTRAL

United Overseas Bank (UOBH.SI)

Rating since Nov 9, 2025

Ratios & Valuation

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
P/E (X)	13.1	11.2	10.7	10.1
Price/PPOP (X)	8.1	7.9	7.6	7.2
P/B (X)	1.2	1.2	1.1	1.1
P/NTA per share (X)	—	—	—	—
Dividend yield (%)	4.4	4.7	4.9	5.1
Div. payout ratio (%)	55.7	50.0	50.0	50.0

Growth & Margins (%)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
BVPS growth	4.1	5.5	5.9	5.8
Total revenue growth	(3.4)	2.4	4.2	4.8
Op. profit growth	(6.9)	2.3	4.8	5.0
Net inc growth	(22.6)	21.0	5.0	5.2
EPS growth	(22.4)	21.5	5.1	5.3
DPS growth	(32.2)	10.9	5.0	5.2

Asset Quality

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Provision charge/total loans (%)	0.6	0.3	0.3	0.3
Gr impaired assets/total loans (%)	1.5	1.7	1.7	1.7
NPL ratio (%)	1.5	1.7	1.7	1.7
Total provisions/total loans (%)	1.2	1.3	1.3	1.4
Specific prov/gr impair assets (%)	24.3	33.7	37.2	38.2
Loan loss reserve/NPLs (%)	80.0	77.7	78.2	82.5

Capital Item

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Basel 3 CET1 ratio (%)	—	—	—	—
Tier 1 capital ratio (%)	16.1	16.0	16.4	16.7

Price Performance

Source: FactSet. Price as of 24 Feb 2026 close.

Income Statement (\$\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net interest income	9,355.0	9,431.7	9,723.2	10,149.8
Net fees	2,569.0	2,816.6	3,064.5	3,317.3
Treasury income	1,367.0	0.0	0.0	0.0
Other operating income	518.0	1,889.9	1,948.7	1,972.5
Total revenue	13,809.0	14,138.2	14,736.4	15,439.6
Compensation & benefits exp.	(3,414.0)	—	—	—
Non-employee costs	(2,744.0)	(6,312.0)	(6,532.9)	(6,826.8)
Pre-provision op. profit	7,651.0	7,826.3	8,203.5	8,612.7
Provision for loans	(1,880.0)	(1,070.8)	(1,107.1)	(1,146.2)
Total provision expense	(2,043.0)	(1,070.8)	(1,107.1)	(1,146.2)
Income/(loss) from associates	79.0	86.9	89.5	92.2
Pre-tax profit	5,656.0	6,842.4	7,185.8	7,558.8
Provision for taxes	(962.0)	(1,163.2)	(1,221.6)	(1,285.0)
Minority interest	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (pre-exceptionals)	4,681.0	5,664.2	5,949.3	6,258.8
Post-tax exceptionals	—	—	—	—
Net inc. (post-exceptionals)	4,562.7	5,545.9	5,830.9	6,140.4
EPS (basic, pre-exception) (\$\$)	2.80	3.46	3.63	3.82
EPS (diluted, pre-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (basic, post-exception) (\$\$)	--	--	--	--
EPS (diluted, post-exception) (\$\$)	2.73	3.32	3.49	3.67
Wtd avg shares out. (diluted) (mn)	1,672.3	1,672.3	1,672.3	1,672.3
Avg. yield on loans (%)	4.4	3.9	3.7	3.6
Gr yld. on int. earning assets (%)	3.9	3.4	3.1	3.1
Cost of fund (%)	2.3	1.8	1.6	1.5
Net interest margin (%)	1.8	1.7	1.7	1.7

Balance Sheet (\$\$ mn)

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Domestic mortgages	84,962.0	87,251.6	90,811.7	95,387.4
Domestic non-mortgages	30,595.0	31,419.5	32,701.5	34,349.2
Domestic commercial lending	216,502.0	222,336.4	231,408.4	243,068.3
Total overseas lending, gross	—	—	—	—
Gross loans to customers	352,180.0	361,670.8	376,428.0	395,394.9
Total NPLs, gross	5,379.0	5,994.1	6,426.9	6,553.1
Total loan loss reserve	4,303.0	4,660.0	5,029.0	5,403.4
Net customer loans & advances	347,877.0	357,010.8	371,398.9	389,991.6
Other interest earning assets	106,769.0	109,171.3	111,668.3	114,256.5
Interest earning assets	540,967.0	565,981.2	589,737.6	615,409.7
Other non-int. earning assets	31,094.0	31,017.5	30,939.3	30,866.7
Total assets	572,061.0	596,998.7	620,676.9	646,276.4
Risk weighted assets	275,990.0	288,021.1	299,444.7	311,795.1
CASA deposits	248,620.0	278,454.4	300,730.8	324,789.2
Non-CASA deposits	177,318.0	170,807.9	169,245.5	167,698.7
Customer deposits	425,938.0	449,262.3	469,976.3	492,487.9
Other paying liabilities	—	—	—	—
Other liabilities	18,722.0	18,722.0	18,722.0	18,722.0
Total liabilities	520,568.0	543,892.3	564,606.3	587,117.9
Total shareholders' equity	51,493.0	53,106.3	56,070.6	59,158.5
Total liabilities & equity	572,061.0	596,998.7	620,676.9	646,276.4
BVPS (\$\$)	29.00	30.61	32.41	34.29
RWA/assets (%)	48.2	48.2	48.2	48.2

Profit Drivers

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Net customer loan growth (%)	4.2	2.6	4.0	5.0
Net interest margin (%)	1.8	1.7	1.7	1.7
Fee income ratio (%)	NM	NM	NM	NM
Cost/income (ex. goodwill) (%)	44.4	44.6	44.3	44.2
Tax rate (%)	17.0	17.0	17.0	17.0
CASA ratio (%)	58.4	62.0	64.0	65.9
Net cust. loans/deposits (%)	81.7	79.5	79.0	79.2

Profitability

	12/25	12/26E	12/27E	12/28E
Op. revenue/avg. assets (%)	2.5	2.4	2.4	2.4
Op. expenses/avg. assets (%)	1.1	1.1	1.1	1.1
Pre-provision ROA (%)	1.4	1.3	1.3	1.4
Loan loss prov./avg. assets (%)	0.3	0.2	0.2	0.2
Pre-tax profit/avg. assets (%)	1.0	1.2	1.2	1.2
Prov. for inc. tax/avg. assets (%)	0.2	0.2	0.2	0.2
ROA (%)	0.8	1.0	1.0	1.0
Leverage (X)	11.1	11.2	11.1	10.9
ROE (%)	9.6	11.2	11.3	11.2
ROE (pre-exception.) (%)	9.2	10.8	10.9	10.9

Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Research estimates.

More details from the briefing:

- **Asset quality - Pressures to remain as CRE concerns lingers.** CRE remains a key pain point for UOB, with the bulk of elevated NPA formation in 4Q25 (S\$599m) still stemming from CRE exposures in Greater China and the US. On the US front, this pressure is further reflected in the sharp increase in GP coverage for the US book to 4.7% from 2.2% in 3Q25, even after the earlier heavy provisions taken in 3Q. Management attributed this to a more conservative, pre-emptive stance on a handful of legacy CRE exposures. That said, management expressed cautious optimism that a portion of these provisions could be repurposed over time as the underlying assets are worked through. Beyond CRE, there were other pockets stress with Singapore seeing a rise in special provisions to S\$124m in 1H24 from S\$45m in 2H24, with pressures largely confined to SME cases, which management characterised as non-systemic. Thailand provisions also remained elevated, reflective of the weaker macro environment. Taken together, this does not yet constitute a clean quarter from an asset quality perspective. Looking ahead, CRE likely to remain a concern still in HK and, while our HK real estate analyst expects some stabilisation to small rises in CRE prices and rents this year, we believe the risk profile remains uneven. UOB has noted HK CRE is not out of the woods and peer banks in HK continue to highlight residual asset quality risk from HK CRE exposures on their balance sheet. We therefore remain watchful on this front.

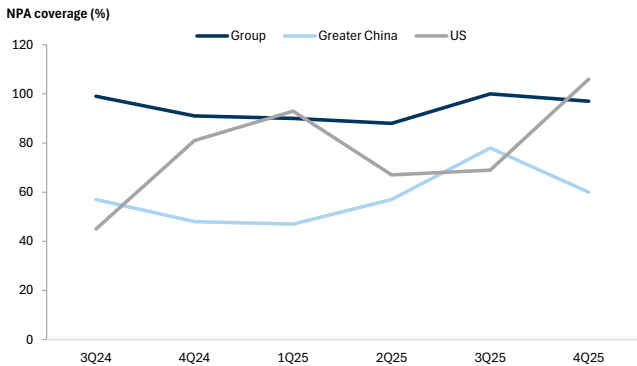
That said UOB has built meaningful buffers and management reiterated that provisioning levels remain sufficient. GP to performing loan coverage remained stable around 1% in 4Q. However, stripping out HK and US we estimate that GP coverage declined to 0.62% from 0.72% in 3Q. Overall given the persistence of CRE related risk, we adopt a more cautious stance and forecast credit cost at the higher end of management guidance at 30bps for 2026–2028.

- **Capital returns - No additional commitment for now.** While CET1 ratio stood at 15.1%, above management's preferred operating range of 14.0–14.5%, and with capital likely to continue to build underpinned by muted RWA growth, management noted that there is no intention to further announce additional returns in the near term as its capital return plan announced at its FY2024 results of S\$3bn capital return programme (comprising special dividends and share buybacks through 2027) the latter is still ongoing only 1/3 of the buyback executed to date. We see the lack of incremental capital return announcement will likely cap upside for the stock as its dividend profile will be less competitive relative to SG bank peers at 4.7% for 2026 vs DBS at 5.7%. Furthermore, the build up in capital could weigh on ROEs.
- **Fee income - Guidance lowered due to weaker loan related fees.** Management noted that the lowering of guidance of fee income growth of high single to low double digit to high single digit growth was mainly due to expectation of lower loan related fees. Management continues to see robust fee growth for the other line items especially wealth.
- **NIM - Guidance is set at 1.75–1.80%, alongside low single-digit loan growth.** UOB expects some near-term softening in NIM, premised on 1–2 Fed rate cuts in 2Q–3Q26, though management sees a muted pass-through to SORA, given its view

that current SORA levels have largely priced in the expected easing cycle. This is supported by the end-Jan'26 exit NIM of 1.82%, only 2bps below 4Q25's 1.84%, pointing to limited incremental downside. From a funding perspective, the Dec'25 repricing of UOB's flagship One Account (last of the 3 adjustments made in 2025) has yet to be reflected in 4Q25 results and should flow through in 2026, providing further support to management's view of contained NIM pressure. On loan growth, UOB maintains a conservative low single-digit outlook, alongside a continued pivot towards trade loans, which now account for ~13% of total loans and are growing at ~26% YoY, versus ~5% YoY overall loan growth. While trade loans carry thinner margins, they are more capital-efficient and offer stronger cross-selling opportunities, particularly across transaction banking and treasury. We forecast NIM of 1.77% and loan growth of 2.7%, and NII growth of 0.8% for 2026.

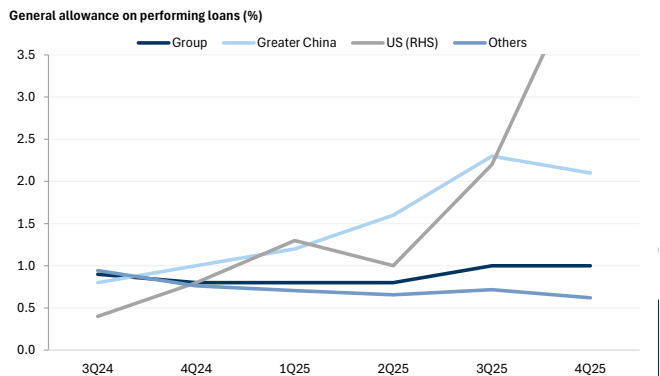
Key risks: (-) Unexpected acceleration or deeper Fed rate cuts; (-) Unexpected deterioration in asset quality; (+) Stronger than expected growth in fee income

Exhibit 1: Group NPA coverage dropped slightly with lower NPA coverage in Greater China and a rise in US.



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Exhibit 2: For general provision coverage, while group remained at 1%, US rose further to 4.7% and with Greater China flattish at 2.1% leaving ex Greater China and US lower



Source: Company data, Goldman Sachs Global Investment Research

Disclosure Appendix

Reg AC

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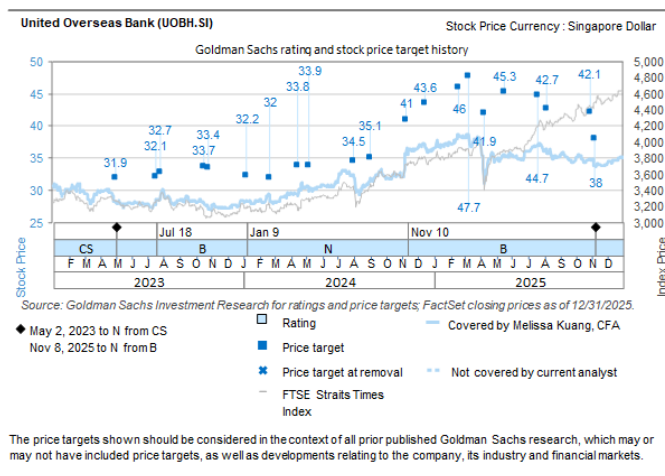
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